

Sameer Kathawate

+1-216-375-3985 | sameerkathawate87@gmail.com | Austin, TX (Open to relocation)

SUMMARY

Quality engineer with 15+ years architecting and scaling automation frameworks across web, mobile (iOS/Android), desktop, and API platforms, with deep expertise validating distributed, cloud-backed systems, CI/CD pipelines, and client/server architectures. Currently driving AI-assisted testing, applying LLM-powered automation to modernize tooling and reduce long-term maintenance. A technical leader and mentor, setting quality standards, influencing automation strategy, and growing senior QE talent.

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/sameerkathawate/>

Blog: medium.com/@sameerkathawate

Portfolio: sameerkathawate.github.io

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Testing & Automation: Playwright, Selenium, Appium, XCUITest, RestAssured, TestNG, JMeter
- Languages: Java, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Swift
- Cloud & CI/CD: AWS, GitHub Actions, CI/CD pipelines, BrowserStack
- AI/ML: TensorFlow, HuggingFace, LLM-powered tooling
- Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB
- Tools: IntelliJ IDEA, Visual Studio, Git, ADB

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AVP Tech, Software Development in Test | LPL Financial, Austin, TX | Jun 2023 – Present

Leading software quality engineering for a financial services technology organization, owning automation strategy, test infrastructure, and AI-driven tooling across multiple high-impact product teams. Architecting the shift from manual quality gates to AI-assisted, data-driven testing across the SDLC.

- Architected and scaled a Playwright-based automation framework from the ground up, supporting reliable UI, API, and integration testing across multiple high-impact product teams — recognized with the Engineering Excellence Award (2025) for driving organizational change in automation practices.
- Built custom AI agents leveraging Playwright MCP to automate and scale browser-based workflows across the organization.
- Built Test-Data as a Service, integrating synthetic data into CI/CD pipelines and GitHub Actions for on-demand, environment-isolated test data creation.
- Built automation and canaries for high-volume move-money services, validating transaction consistency, alerting, and resiliency.
- Identified and resolved neglected MFA gaps by implementing TOTP-based authentication in test infrastructure, unblocking 400+ test cases and restoring automated coverage.
- Defined and implemented a 3D quality model extending the traditional test pyramid — expanding testing beyond layers to include functional, non-functional, and data-driven dimensions across the SDLC, adopted across multiple product teams.
- Mentoring 3 QE engineers, supporting their growth in automation ownership and technical decision-making.

Sr. Product Quality Engineer | Upstart, Austin, TX | Feb 2022 – Apr 2023

Owned test strategy and automation for Upstart's lending platform from the ground up, leading a cross-functional QE team across compliance-driven, multi-workstream product launches. Partnered with product, compliance, and operations to scale quality coverage org-wide under tight resource constraints.

- Led 6 QE engineers across 8 concurrent workstreams to design and execute test plans for a major multi-product launch, coordinating with product, compliance, operations, and quality analysts to close business and regulatory gaps.
- Increased daily monolith deployment frequency by 300% by expanding automation coverage and eliminating manual testing bottlenecks.

- Designed and executed iOS test strategy for the Upstart mobile application and integrated Playwright with BrowserStack, extending coverage from web-only to cross-device, cross-browser testing.

Quality Engineer II | Amazon, Seattle, WA & Austin, TX | Jun 2015 – Feb 2022

Owned quality engineering across Alexa Music, Echo/FireTV devices, and Amazon Business — spanning firmware certification, CI/CD integration, and international launch readiness. Partnered with hardware, firmware, and external streaming partners to ship reliable experiences to millions of customers, while leading an offshore QA team.

- Re-architected Alexa Music's end-to-end test suite to align with the Music Kit API model, increasing test coverage by 35% and establishing a scalable testing pattern adopted across device integrations.
- Spearheaded development of automated test infrastructure and internal tooling using cloud technologies and embedded systems — reducing regression testing time by 40% and enabling continuous delivery across Amazon Business and Alexa Music.
- Led end-to-end integration testing for Spotify and Apple Music on Alexa, collaborating directly with the external Apple Music QA team to validate HLS streaming and deliver seamless playback for millions of customers across Echo, Alexa Show, and FireTV devices.
- Owned firmware QA strategy for Alexa Echo devices — defining quality gates, executing Build Verification Tests, and certifying GA firmware releases in partnership with hardware build teams.
- Drove full CI/CD integration for Amazon Business and Alexa Music, embedding UI (Selenium/TestNG) and API (RestAssured) test suites into the pipeline and reducing pre-release validation overhead by 40%.
- Built Appium and XCUITest automation for Amazon Business, reducing manual testing effort by 20% and extending mobile coverage across regulated categories (medical, beauty) with special licensing requirements; led i18N and L10N testing to launch successfully across multiple international marketplaces.
- Mentored and managed 8 offshore QA engineers for Alexa Music manual voice testing — establishing quality standards, coordinating test cycles, and incorporating beta feedback into improvements that raised user satisfaction ratings by 15%.

Quality Engineer | Qualcomm, San Diego, CA | Apr 2013 – Feb 2015

Managed quality across multiple chipset and OS compliance programs, overseeing design, development, testing, and delivery to ensure products met regulatory and industry standards. Certified third-party vendors and OEM hardware for global device launches.

- Certified Snapdragon chipset for graphical user experience and Bluetooth/WiFi connectivity across prototype and OEM devices for Samsung and OnePlus.
- Assessed and certified third-party vendors to execute compliance testing for Firefox OS (B2G)-enabled devices on behalf of an industry consortium.
- Designed test plans and KPIs for the Compliance Review Board (CRB) covering devices running the B2G operating system, collaborating with Wireless, Display, Connectivity, and Camera teams on end-to-end device test plans.

Earlier Experience

- Software Engineer, Bluecoat Systems, Bangalore, India (2009 – 2011) — Test automation and SDK integration for ProxyAV, a malware-scanning and protection appliance, prior to graduate studies.

Education

- Master of Science, Computer Science — San Diego State University, San Diego, CA (2011–2014)

Awards & Recognition

- Engineering Excellence Award — LPL Financial (2025): Led end-to-end creation of the Playwright automation framework and drove organizational change in automation practices.